

17th August 2026

The Director General,
Disaster Management Centre,
Vidya Mawatha,
Colombo 07,
Sri Lanka.

Dear Sir/Madam,

REQUEST FOR HISTORICAL DISASTER IMPACT DATA FOR A FINAL-YEAR UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH PROJECT – “INTEGRATED FLOOD AND LANDSLIDE RISK ASSESSMENT AND RESPONSE SYSTEM FOR SRI LANKA” (PROJECT ID: J26-IT-334)

We are final-year BSc (Hons) in Information Technology undergraduates at the Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology (SLIIT), specialising in Artificial Intelligence under the Center of Excellence for AI (CEAI). We are jointly conducting our final-year research project titled “Integrated Flood and Landslide Risk Assessment and Response System for Sri Lanka” (Project ID: J26-IT-334), under the supervision of Dr. Kapila Dissanayaka (Supervisor) and Mr. Uchira Wickramarathne (Co-Supervisor).

The project develops an AI-driven, multi-hazard platform integrating landslide prediction, early warning decision support, and emergency response resource coordination for Sri Lanka. Three of us are directly requesting data for our respective components, as detailed below:

- Bagya R M S (IT23394124) – Landslide Prediction and Forecasting Component
- Prathibhani Y.L.O.L (IT23317512) – Early Warning Decision Support Component
- Palihena M.B (IT23411562) – Emergency Response and Resource Coordination Component

Further to the guidance provided by Ms. Samanmali Matharaarachchi, Assistant Director (Research & Development), DMC, in her email dated 17th August 2026, we are pleased to submit the following formal request outlining the required datasets, time period, geographical level, disaster types, and specific variables.

1. Scope of Request

- Disaster types: Landslides and Floods
- Time period: 2006 – 2026 (last 20 years), or the longest period for which digitised records are available
- Geographical level: District, Divisional Secretariat (DS) Division, and Grama Niladhari (GN) Division, or event coordinates where available
- Geographic focus: Nuwara Eliya District – specifically the Ambagamuwa, Kotmale, and Walapane DS Divisions – for the landslide prediction component (finer GN-division-level detail preferred for this district); island-wide / multi-district coverage for the decision support and emergency response components

2. Datasets Requested

a) Historical Disaster Event and Human-Impact Records (Landslide Prediction & Decision Support components)

Category	Specific Variables Requested
Disaster type	Landslide or flood, per event
Date / year of disaster	Event date (day/month/year where available)

Location	District, DS Division, GN Division, or coordinates
Severity / hazard information	Hazard level, magnitude, or severity classification
Human impact	Number of deaths, injured persons, and missing persons
Displacement	Number of evacuated / displaced persons
Overall impact	Total number of affected persons
Housing damage	Number of affected / damaged houses
Other information	Any other available human-impact or disaster-damage information

b) Historical Landslide Inventory Data (Landslide Prediction component)

Category	Specific Variables Requested
Landslide point locations	Historical landslide occurrence points (coordinates or GN Division), 2006–2026
Landslide date / time	Date (and time, if recorded) of each historical landslide event
Landslide type / mechanism	Type of failure (e.g., debris slide, rockfall, slump), where classified
Hazard zonation	Existing landslide hazard zone classification for Nuwara Eliya District, if held by DMC
Associated rainfall / trigger data	Rainfall amount or trigger conditions recorded against each event, where available
Recurrence information	Any records of reactivation or repeat landslides at the same site

c) Shelter / Safety Centre Data (Emergency Response component)

Category	Specific Variables Requested
Shelter / safety centre locations	Registered shelter and safety centre locations (point data)
Capacity	Maximum capacity and, if available, current/historical occupancy
Facilities	Available facilities (water, sanitation, power, etc.), if recorded

d) Road and Bridge Damage Records (Emergency Response component)

Category	Specific Variables Requested
Road / bridge damage counts	Number of damaged roads and bridges, by district and by disaster event

e) Relief Stock / Non-Food Item (NFI) Records (Emergency Response component)

Category	Specific Variables Requested
Relief stock / NFI availability patterns	Historical inventory / stock-level records at warehouse or district level

f) Situation Reports and PDNA Reports (Emergency Response component – historical validation)

Category	Specific Variables Requested
Named-event situation reports	DMC situation reports for major past flood/landslide events

Post-Disaster Needs Assessment (PDNA) reports	PDNA or equivalent documents, where available
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g) Administrative Boundaries and Facility Registry (used across all three components)

Category	Specific Variables Requested
Administrative boundaries	District / DS Division / GN Division boundary layers
Facility registry	Any associated registry of DMC/DDMCU facilities used for emergency coordination, where available

3. Purpose and Data Use

The requested data will be used strictly for academic research purposes: to train and validate machine-learning models for landslide risk prediction, to benchmark and validate a multi-hazard early warning decision support system, and to model historical emergency response and resource-allocation patterns. All data will be handled in accordance with SLIIT's research ethics and data privacy guidelines, used solely within the scope of this project, and not shared with third parties or used for any commercial purpose. We are glad to sign any data-usage agreement or non-disclosure undertaking the Centre may require.

4. Format

We would be grateful to receive the data in any digitally accessible format available to the Centre – e.g., CSV, Excel, shapefile/GeoJSON, or PDF reports – whichever is most convenient for your team to provide.

We would be most grateful for your kind consideration of this request and for any guidance on the availability and procedure for obtaining the above datasets. Please do not hesitate to contact us or our supervisor should any clarification be required.

Thank you for your time and support.

Yours faithfully,

Dr. Kapila Dissanayaka
Supervisor, SLIIT

Mr. Uchira Wickramaratne
Co-Supervisor, SLIIT